

Intermediate elective option 2

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1. Set up

Packages

```
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(janitor)
library(snakecase)

# wrapping axis labels
library(scales)

# reading in .xlsx files
library(readxl)

# arranging plots
library(patchwork)
```

Data

```
# taxonomic information
taxon_list <- read_csv(here("data", "taxon_list.csv"))

# aquatic invertebrates
aq_ins <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
                   sheet = "Aquatic Insects")
```

```
# site information
sites <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
                  sheet = "sites")

# water quality information
water_quality <- read_xlsx(here("data", "Aquatic Sampling
↪ Data-2026-03-10.xlsx"),
                          sheet = "Water Quality",
                          na = c("", "n/a", "N/A", "over", "173+"))
```

2. Cleaning

sites object

```
# creating new object from sites
ncos_sites <- sites |>
  # filter to only include NCOS sites sampled four times a year
  filter(sector == "NCOS" & sampling_frequency == "Quarterly")
```

Cleaning taxon_list

```
# creating new clean object from taxon_list
taxon_list_clean <- taxon_list |>
  # converting taxon name to snake case (no spaces or capital letters,
  # only underscores)
  mutate(verbatim_name = to_any_case(verbatim_name, case = "snake"))
```

Cleaning water_quality

```
# creating new clean object from water quality
water_quality_clean <- water_quality |>
  # clean column names
  clean_names() |>
  # filtering join: only include sites in ncos_sites
  semi_join(ncos_sites, by = "site") |>
```

```

# create new column to join with later data frames
unite("date_site", date, site, remove = TRUE) |>
# group by date_site column
group_by(date_site) |>
# calculate median pH, salinity, DO
summarize(med_ph = median(p_h, na.rm = TRUE),
          med_sal = median(salinity_ppt, na.rm = TRUE),
          med_do = median(dissolved_oxygen_mg_l, na.rm = TRUE)) |>
# ungroup data frame
ungroup() |>
# filter out salinity outliers
filter(date_site != "2022-08-12_NVBR")

```

Cleaning aq_ins

```

# creating new clean object from aquatic inverts
aq_ins_clean <- aq_ins |>
# clean column names
clean_names() |>
# filtering join: only include sites occurring in ncos_sites
semi_join(ncos_sites, by = c("site")) |>
# renaming columns
rename(date = date_on_vial) |>
# select columns of interest
select(date, sample_type, site,
       ostracod,
       copepod,
       hemiptera_corixidae_boatman,
       cladocera,
       nematode,
       diptera_ceratopogonidae,
       annelida_oligochaete,
       diptera_chironomid,
       annelida_polychaete) |>
# filter to only include "filtered beaker" samples
filter(sample_type %in% c("FB 250", "FB250")) |>
# convert the data frame to long format
pivot_longer(cols = ostracod:annelida_polychaete,
             names_to = "taxon",
             values_to = "abundance") |>

```

```

# group by date, site, taxon
group_by(date, site, taxon) |>
# calculate average abundance per liter (sum abundance divided by 7.5
  ↳ liters)
summarize(ave_lit = sum(abundance, na.rm = TRUE)/7.5) |>
# ungroup data frame
ungroup() |>
# create a new column called `date_site` to join with water quality
unite("date_site", date, site, remove = FALSE) |>
# join with water quality
left_join(water_quality_clean, by = c("date_site")) |>
# join with taxon list
left_join(taxon_list_clean, by = c("taxon" = "verbatim_name")) |>
# add full names of sites
mutate(site_full = case_when(
  site == "NVBR" ~ "North of Venoco Bridge",
  site == "NEC" ~ "South of Venoco Bridge",
  site == "NMC" ~ "Main Channel",
  site == "NPB" ~ "South of Phelps Bridge",
  site == "NPB1" ~ "North of Phelps Bridge",
  site == "NPB2" ~ "Phelps Road",
  site == "NWP" ~ "West Pond",
  site == "NDC" ~ "Devereux Creek"
)) |>
# setting factor levels for site
mutate(site_full = fct_reorder(site_full, med_sal, .fun = "median", .na_rm
  ↳ = TRUE),
  site_full = fct_rev(site_full))

```

Problem 1. Explain your inspiration

Which visualization you chose for your inspiration

- I chose Cédric Scherer's Bill Dimensions of Brush-tailed Penguins (TidyTuesday 2020/31). Panel A of his figure is a scatter plot of bill length vs. bill depth coloured by penguin species. There are two signature techniques I am copying: two-layer `geom_point`, which is a filled layer for the body of each point and a transparent layer with a white outline on top, and per-species text labels placed at fixed positions showing the species name in bold colour with a lightened multi-line stats block immediately below.

Why it makes sense for your dataset of choice.

- The cleaned aquatic invertebrate data has the structure Panel A was built for. There are two continuous variables per observation, median salinity at the survey and log-transformed abundance per L. It is a small number of groups to color by, and a continuous variable to map onto bubble size. The labelled blocks let each group carry its own median statistics inside the plot rather than in a side legend.

Which variables from your dataset will be shown in your visualization, and what visual components they map onto (axes, shapes, colors, etc.)

- x-axis: med_sal median salinity
- y-axis: log_ave_lit = $\log(\text{ave_lit} + 1)$
- point colour and label colour: taxon_group , Microcrustaceans, Aquatic insects and Worms, which are 3 taxa each
- point size: ave_lit, average abundance per L
- group name + median salinity, median log abundance: per-group label block

Problem 2. Plan your figure

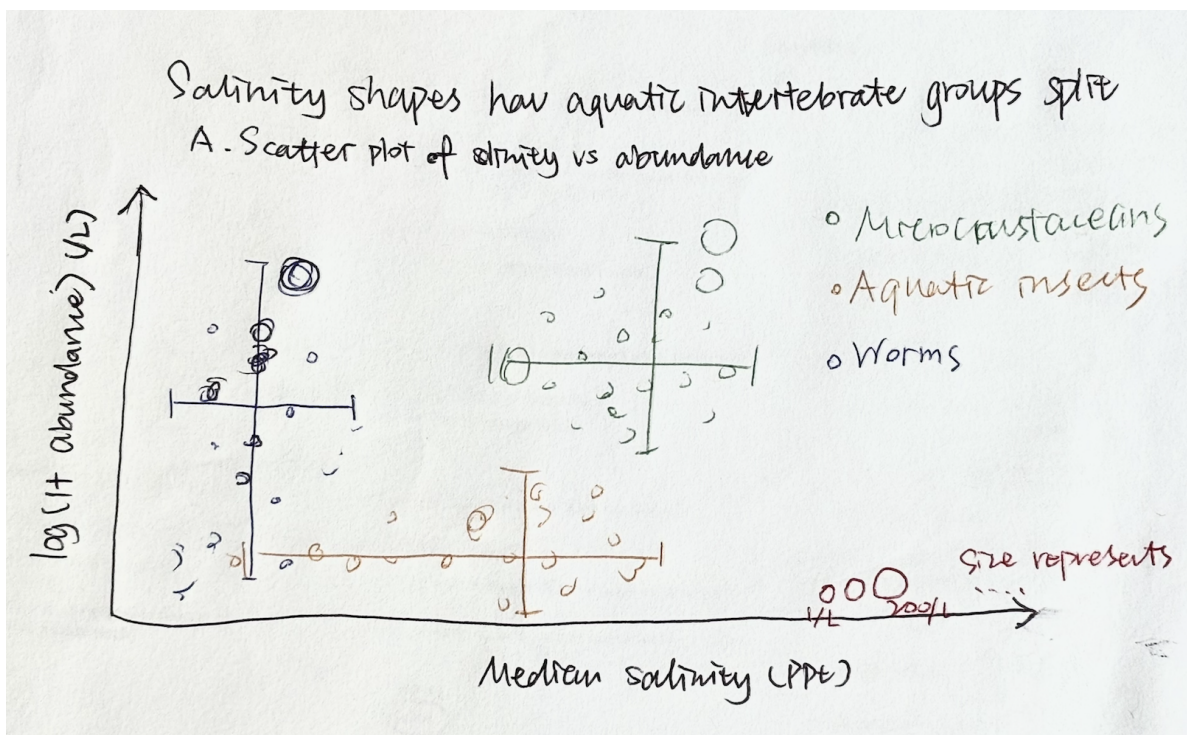


Figure 1: Planning sketch of the figure.

Problem 3. Code your figure

3a. Wrangle

```
# collapse the 9 surveyed taxa into 3 ecological groups
group_lookup <- tribble(
  ~taxon,                ~taxon_group,
  "ostracod",            "Microcrustaceans",
  "copepod",             "Microcrustaceans",
  "cladocera",           "Microcrustaceans",
  "hemiptera_corixidae_boatman", "Aquatic insects",
  "diptera_ceratopogonidae",    "Aquatic insects",
  "diptera_chironomid",         "Aquatic insects",
  "annelida_oligochaete",       "Worms",
  "annelida_polychaete",        "Worms",
  "nematode",                   "Worms"
)

# build the data frame the figure will read from
fig_data <- aq_ins_clean |>
  # attach the 3-group ecological label
  left_join(group_lookup, by = "taxon") |>
  # focus on presences (abundance > 0)
  filter(ave_lit > 0) |>
  # drop surveys that have no matching water quality reading
  filter(!is.na(med_sal)) |>
  # log + 1 transform abundance so the scatter spreads out
  mutate(log_ave_lit = log(ave_lit + 1),
    # factor order: micro - insects - worms
    taxon_group = factor(taxon_group,
      levels = c("Microcrustaceans",
        "Aquatic insects",
        "Worms")))

```